



▲ **FC Daly in his 1916 book** *Manual of Criminal Classes Operating in Bengal* notes that many “criminal tribes” were very clever at disguising themselves. Here, a group of robbers can be seen dressed in turbans and dhotis to avoid suspicion.

A darker, unexpected, yet inevitable, by-product of the railways was a new class of criminals. They waited for opportune moments to strike – some drugged passengers, or occasionally slit their throats, before making off with their belongings. Others conned trusting, distracted travellers or looted freight and sheds for rolling stock and goods. No one was exempt. Anyone could be a victim, even a first-class passenger. Bengal’s deputy inspector general of Police, FC Daly wrote in his 1916 book *Manual of Criminal Classes Operating in Bengal*, how an ingenious thief once “lifted His Excellency, the Governor of Bombay’s valuable